Leave Policy

Kestrel Data Labs Pvt. Ltd. (fictional company created for this project)

1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains the types of leave available to employees of Kestrel Data Labs and how leave is requested, approved and recorded. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees in India. Interns and contractors are covered by their own engagement letters and are not covered by this policy.

2. Leave year

The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. All leave balances are tracked in the HR portal, PeopleDesk, and employees can see their live balance there at any time.

3. Annual (earned) leave

Full-time employees receive 24 days of annual leave per leave year. Annual leave accrues at 2 days per completed month of service. Part-time employees receive annual leave on a pro-rata basis according to their contracted hours. New joiners can use annual leave only after completing their 3-month probation.

4. Carry forward and encashment

Employees may carry forward a maximum of 10 unused annual leave days into the next leave year. Any unused balance above 10 days lapses on 31 December and is not paid out, except on resignation, when up to 15 accrued days are encashed at the basic salary rate.

5. Applying for leave

Planned annual leave must be applied for in PeopleDesk at least 7 calendar days in advance. Leave of more than 5 consecutive working days needs at least 21 days' notice and approval from both the reporting manager and the department head. Managers should respond to a request within 3 working days.

6. Sick leave

Employees receive 12 days of paid sick leave per leave year. Sick leave cannot be carried forward. A medical certificate is required for sick leave of more than 2 consecutive days.

7. Parental and family leave

Maternity leave: 26 weeks of paid leave for the first two children, in line with the Maternity Benefit Act. Paternity leave: 10 working days of paid leave, to be taken within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption. Bereavement leave: 5 working days on the death of an immediate family member.

8. Public holidays

The company observes 12 public holidays each year. The holiday list is published in December for the following year. Employees who are required to work on a public holiday receive a compensatory day off, to be used within 60 days.

9. Leave without pay

Leave without pay of up to 30 days may be granted once annual leave is exhausted, with department head and HR approval.